

Ben Akoka

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Statistics and Data Science student at UC Santa Barbara with experience in data analytics, AI research, and consulting, leveraging Python, R, SQL, and statistical analysis to transform complex data into actionable insights. Experienced in translating data into strategic recommendations through industry, research, and consulting projects.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Taboola, Inc.

Data Analyst & SEO Strategy Paid Intern

Remote

June 2025 – September 2025

- Analyzed 200+ webpages across Taboola's AI, seasonal, and marketing hub domains to identify content performance trends, keyword opportunities, and SEO optimization strategies across diverse content categories.
- Conducted competitive benchmarking and keyword research across 12+ competitors to uncover search gaps, evaluate ranking performance, and develop recommendations to improve organic visibility.
- Built and presented 8+ strategy reports using Google Search Console, Looker Studio, Ahrefs, and internal analytics tools to translate performance data into actionable SEO initiatives for cross-functional stakeholders.

UCSB Center for AI and Society

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Santa Barbara, CA

August 2026 – Present

- Conducting research with Professor David Lawson on gender attribution bias in AI-generated summaries through human and AI transmission-chain experiments.
- Contributing to literature reviews, experimental design, IRB preparation, and data collection using Prolific to evaluate AI-generated outputs from large language models including ChatGPT and Gemini.

TAMID Group

Project Manager

Santa Barbara, CA

January 2025 – Present

- Conducting market research, customer segmentation, and competitive analysis for an AI startup.
- Developed strategic recommendations for stakeholders that informed product development and go-to-market strategy.

Heschel Day School

IT Technician

Northridge, CA

June 2022 – September 2024

- Inspected, repaired, and audited laptops, projectors, and tablets to identify issues.
- Extracted and transferred GPU, RAM, hard drives, and CPU from faulty PCs.
- Assisted the entire teaching staff and other faculty with individualized technological issues.
- Created graphics, slideshows, and videos for marketing campaigns.

UC Santa Barbara Tour Guide Association

Campus Tour Guide

Santa Barbara, CA

January 2026 – Present

- Lead engaging campus tours for prospective students and families.
- Showcase UCSB academics, campus life, and student experience through engaging storytelling and personalized interactions.

Tutoring

Self-Employed

Online

February 2020 – Present

- Provide individualized instruction to students ages 12–18 in mathematics, English, and history through virtual and in-person sessions.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Barbara

Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Statistics and Data Science

Santa Barbara, CA

September 2024 – Present

- Graduation date: June 2027; GPA: 3.87
- Honors Program; Technology Management Program
- Relevant Coursework: Probability & Statistics, Statistical Modeling, Data Science Concepts & Analysis, Linear Algebra, Computer Science (Python)

Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate

- Applied spreadsheets, R, and SQL to clean, analyze, and visualize data for business problem-solving.

Online

September 2024

SKILLS & INVOLVEMENTS

- Programming: Python, R, SQL
- Analytics: Excel, Google Sheets, Looker Studio, Google Search Console, Ahrefs
- Methods: Data Cleaning, Data Visualization, Statistical Analysis, SEO Analytics
- Alpha Epsilon Pi Executive Board - Director of Recruitment; lead recruitment efforts and coordinate campus events